General Assembly

STUDY GUIDE

ADJUSTING LAYOUT WITH CSS

The Box Model

To help visualize the way layouts work in CSS, imagine every HTML element with a box around it. These invisible boxes guide the way browsers arrange HTML elements.

The parts of an HTML box are:

- **Content:** whatever you added in HTML.
- **Padding:** the space between the content and the border of the box.
- **Border:** the border around the content and padding.
- **Margin:** the space around the border.

You can adjust an entire "box" or just one side. Sides are styled clockwise, in **TRouBLe** order - Top, Right, Bottom, Left.

Display Settings

All HTML elements have default display settings: block or inline.

Block Elements	Inline Elements
Always start on a new line.	Sit within the content that surrounds them.
Take up the full width available on the screen.	Only take up as much space as necessary.
Stack on top of each other when new ones are added.	Render in one line.
Can have set margins, padding, widths, or heights.	Cannot have set margins or padding.
<h1-6>, , <p>, , etc.	<a>, , <img>, etc.

You can override these defaults with the display property in CSS using these values:

- none: the element won't display at all
- inline: the element will display in one horizontal line
- block: the element will take up the entire width of the page
- inline-block: elements will sit next to each other (inline) but you can add block properties (margin, padding, width, and height)

Sizing an Element

- width controls an element's width
- height controls an element's height
- If you set just one, the browser will adjust the other proportionally. If you set both, you will override the original proportions and may distort your image.

Positioning an Element

- **Relative positioning** means the element is positioned relative to its normal position on the page, independent of other elements.
- **Absolute positioning** is relative to a parent element with a set position.
    - If an element doesn't have a parent, or its parent doesn't have a set position, it will be adjusted relative to the body of the document.

- Use top, right, bottom, and left with distance values to tell the browser how far from the sides of the page - or other elements - an element should be displayed.